

9. Set a session after user's login; maintain the user's data with session. Destroy the session and its data after a period of time.

□ Meaning of This Practical

- This practical is about Session Management in PHP.
- It means:
- When a user logs in, we create a session.
- We store the user's data (like username) in the session.
- The session keeps the user logged in while browsing different pages.
- After a fixed time (for example 30 seconds or 5 minutes), the session automatically expires.
- When the session expires, all stored data is deleted and the user must login again.

1. What is Session?

A session is a server-side technique used to store user data across multiple pages.

- Created using `session_start()`
- Data stored in `$_SESSION` superglobal array
- Data remains until browser closes or session is destroyed

2. Steps performed in program

Step	Description
1	User enters username in login form
2	<code>session_start()</code> creates session
3	Username stored in <code>\$_SESSION['username']</code>
4	<code>last_activity</code> time is stored
5	If inactivity > 30 seconds → session destroyed
6	User must login again

3. Functions Used

- `session_start()` → Start session
- `$_SESSION[]` → Store session data
- `time()` → Get current time

- session_unset() → Remove all session variables
 - session_destroy() → Destroy session completely
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□ Output Flow

1. User logs in.
2. Session stores username.
3. If user stays inactive for 30 seconds:
 - Session automatically expires.
 - Message: "Session expired. Please login again."

□ Step 1: Login Page (login.php)

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <title>Login Page</title>
</head>
<body>
  <h2>User Login</h2>
  <form method="post" action="welcome.php">
    Username: <input type="text" name="username" required><br><br>
    <input type="submit" value="Login">
  </form>
</body>
</html>
```

□ Step 2: Create Session & Set Timeout (welcome.php)

```
// Set session timeout duration (in seconds)
$timeout_duration = 30; // 30 seconds

// Check if session is already set
if(isset($_SESSION['last_activity'])) {

  // Calculate session lifetime
  if(time() - $_SESSION['last_activity'] > $timeout_duration) {

    // Last request was more than 30 seconds ago
    session_unset(); // Unset session variables
    session_destroy(); // Destroy session
```

```
        echo "Session expired. Please login again.";
        exit();
    }
}

// Update last activity time
$_SESSION['last_activity'] = time();

// Store user data in session
if(isset($_POST['username'])) {
    $_SESSION['username'] = $_POST['username'];
}

// Display welcome message
if(isset($_SESSION['username'])) {
    echo "<h2>Welcome " . $_SESSION['username'] . "</h2>";
    echo "<p>Your session will expire after 30 seconds of inactivity.</p>";
}
?>
```